

BuyWise Overview

Last updated: May 12, 2026

This document is intentionally honest about the current product. BuyWise is live at trybuywise.com, and the app now has working account creation, login, logout, saved items, Supabase syncing, and a real link-analysis flow. The analyzer is still not a universal web scraper. It reads public page data when a site exposes enough readable metadata or server-rendered text, and it asks for manual confirmation when the product, price, or source cannot be trusted.

1. What BuyWise Is

BuyWise is a buyer-focused product-link analyzer. A user pastes a resale listing or retail product link, and BuyWise tries to answer one question:

Is this actually a good place to buy this item?

The product is aimed at normal buyers, not professional resellers. The first users are people checking laptops, cameras, bikes, monitors, electronics, retail deals, and used listings from places like eBay, Craigslist, OfferUp, Amazon, Best Buy, Walmart, Target, Apple, B&H, StockX, and GOAT.

BuyWise is meant to protect the buyer first. A cheap listing with weak proof should not receive a high final score just because the price looks low.

2. Current Live Infrastructure

The current site is live at trybuywise.com.

Working infrastructure:

- Next.js App Router frontend
- TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS
- Supabase Auth
- Supabase database
- Account signup
- Login
- Logout
- Saved items
- Saved verdict syncing
- Saved item create/read/update/delete
- Vercel hosting
- GitHub-connected deployment

The app also works locally at <http://localhost:3000> when the Next.js dev server is running.

3. Main User Flow

The primary flow is:

1. User pastes a resale or retail product link.
2. BuyWise normalizes the URL.
3. BuyWise tries to read public page data.
4. BuyWise extracts any reliable product title, description, source, and price.
5. BuyWise tries to match the product to an internal benchmark.
6. If the product or price is uncertain, BuyWise asks the user to confirm the mi

ssing fields.

7. Once the minimum details are reliable enough, BuyWise generates a verdict page.

8. The user can save the verdict to their account.

4. What The Analyzer Can Currently Read

The analyzer uses safe public-page parsing only.

It can use:

- JSON-LD product data
- JSON-LD offer data
- OpenGraph metadata
- Twitter card metadata
- embedded structured page data
- visible server-rendered page text
- final redirected URL after normal HTTP redirects

It does not use:

- headless browser scraping
- browser farms
- CAPTCHA bypassing
- logged-in scraping
- private marketplace scraping
- OpenAI-generated facts
- hallucinated prices
- fake live market data

5. URL Normalization

Before extraction, BuyWise tries to clean and normalize pasted links.

Current normalization handles:

- missing protocol, such as ebay.com/item/...
- mobile hostnames, such as m.example.com
- common tracking parameters
- redirect wrapper parameters when they contain a real URL
- shortened/redirected links when the server follows a normal redirect

This improves link handling, but it does not guarantee every marketplace URL can be read.

6. Supported Sites And Reality

BuyWise has best-effort support for:

- Amazon
- eBay
- Craigslist
- Apple
- Best Buy
- Walmart
- Target
- B&H
- StockX
- GOAT

Support means:

- The app recognizes the source.
- The app attempts safe metadata extraction.
- The app can score the deal when enough reliable product and price information is available.

Support does not mean:

- Every page will work.
- Every page exposes a reliable price.
- Every site allows automated reading.
- BuyWise has full live market comps for that category.

Some sites block server requests, hide price data behind client-side scripts, show financing prices, show coupon values, or expose unrelated suggested-product prices. When that happens, BuyWise should ask for manual confirmation instead of pretending the extraction succeeded.

7. Price Extraction

Price extraction is now stricter than the earlier version.

The analyzer tries to identify:

- JSON-LD offer price
- JSON-LD product price
- OpenGraph product price
- visible page price
- embedded structured page price

Every price candidate gets a confidence score and a source explanation.

Examples:

- "Detected JSON-LD offer price: \$999."
- "Detected OpenGraph product price: \$420."
- "A possible \$10 price was found, but it looks too low for this product and may be shipping, financing, or unrelated page text."

The analyzer is designed to reject or downgrade:

- shipping prices
- delivery prices
- financing prices
- monthly-payment numbers
- coupon amounts
- accessory prices
- protection-plan prices
- gift-card amounts
- "starting at" marketing prices
- crossed-out list prices
- suggested-product prices
- tiny unrelated prices
- hidden metadata junk

This directly addresses the earlier serious issue where an Amazon MacBook page produced a false \$10 price and an inflated score.

If price confidence is too low, BuyWise should not score the deal until the user

confirms the actual price.

8. Product Matching

BuyWise still uses internal product benchmarks for comparison. These are not shown as the primary product concept, but they remain important infrastructure.

Current benchmark coverage:

- 5 cameras
- 5 laptops
- 5 bikes
- 5 monitors

Product matching is now more cautious.

The analyzer should not silently map vague product text to a specific old benchmark.

Example:

If a link only says "Apple MacBook" without a clear chip, model, generation, or year, BuyWise should not automatically treat it as "MacBook Air M1."

Instead, it should:

- show low match confidence
- ask for confirmation
- use the user-selected benchmark cautiously
- lower the final score if the match remains uncertain

Matching works best when the link or user-provided text includes specific model details like:

- MacBook Air M1
- Sony A6400
- Trek FX 3
- Dell UltraSharp U2720Q
- Canon EOS R10

9. Current Scoring Philosophy

The main score is the Deal Score out of 100.

The score is intended to represent the overall quality, safety, and value of the listing or product link.

It combines:

- price attractiveness
- trust and safety
- condition
- market competitiveness
- extraction confidence
- price confidence
- product-match confidence
- listing completeness
- source reliability
- warranty or return protection when available
- red flags

- positive trust signals

Scores are intentionally harder to earn now.

Important scoring rules:

- Very cheap prices can increase suspicion.
- High-risk listings should not receive very high final scores.
- Low extraction confidence reduces the final score.
- Weak product matching reduces the final score.
- Weak price confidence reduces the final score.
- Missing trust signals reduce trust and safety.
- A low price alone should not create a 90+ score.

The analyzer separates:

- Price / Value
- Trust / Safety
- Product Condition
- Market Fit
- Confidence
- Final Deal Score

This means a listing can have a strong price but still receive a cautious final score if trust, proof, or extraction quality is weak.

10. Verdict Page

The verdict page now focuses on the overall Deal Score first.

Current verdict output includes:

- large Deal Score out of 100
- market position label
- final recommendation badge
- risk level
- short verdict explanation
- suggested offer or target buy range
- confidence level
- confidence reasons
- subscores
- "Why this score?" breakdown
- pros
- cons
- red flags
- trust signals
- better retail moves, if meaningful
- better resale moves, if meaningful
- questions to ask
- compared-against / data sources section
- save verdict button

Market position labels can include:

- Excellent Deal
- Strong Deal
- Fair Market Price
- Slightly Overpriced
- High Risk Bargain
- Likely Overpriced
- Suspicious Listing

Confidence is shown as:

- High confidence
- Medium confidence
- Low confidence

The app explains why confidence is high, medium, or low.

11. Saved Accounts And Saved Items

Users can create an account and save products or verdicts.

Saved item behavior:

- Logged-out users can save locally on the device.
- Logged-in users sync saved items to Supabase.
- Users can view saved items on the Saved page.
- Users can update saved item status.
- Users can delete saved items.

Supabase row-level security is configured so authenticated users should only access their own rows.

12. What BuyWise Does Not Do Yet

BuyWise does not yet have:

- full real-time marketplace comps
- universal extraction from every website
- Facebook Marketplace scraping
- screenshot upload
- image analysis
- browser extension extraction
- live sold-comps database
- OpenAI analysis
- automated seller-profile trust scoring
- category coverage beyond the current internal benchmark set

The app should not pretend these exist.

13. Facebook Marketplace

BuyWise does not fetch Facebook Marketplace pages.

Reason:

Facebook Marketplace often requires login, blocks automated reading, and is not a good target for direct scraping.

Current fallback:

- User pastes the title.
- User enters the price.
- User pastes seller description or messages.
- BuyWise analyzes the text and confirmed price.

Future options:

- screenshot upload
- OCR from screenshots
- browser extension that reads user-visible page content with permission

14. Screenshot Upload Feasibility

Screenshot upload is realistic, but it should be a future version after the current text/link analyzer is stable.

Clean implementation plan:

1. Add screenshot upload to the analyzer.
2. Store the image temporarily or process client-side if possible.
3. Use OCR to extract title, price, location, description, and seller wording.
4. Show extracted fields for user confirmation.
5. Run the same confidence-aware scoring logic.
6. Later, add image checks for stock photos, blurry images, missing serials, visible damage, and missing accessories.

This is useful for Facebook Marketplace and other blocked pages, but it adds product complexity and should not replace the current safer manual fallback yet.

15. Current Technical Limitations

The biggest current limitation is that BuyWise can only analyze what it can safely read or what the user confirms.

Known limitations:

- some eBay pages may hide or vary price metadata
- Best Buy may timeout or block server reads
- Amazon may expose unrelated prices or hidden page data
- Apple pages may expose broad product names without exact matching detail
- marketplaces may show shipping, financing, or promotional prices near the real price
- product matching still depends on the current benchmark set
- alternatives come from current internal benchmarks, not live web-wide inventory

The app now handles these limitations more honestly by lowering confidence, asking for missing fields, and avoiding overconfident scores.

16. Current Build Direction

BuyWise is moving away from being a price-guide site and toward being a live deal intelligence tool.

Short-term:

- keep internal benchmarks as scoring infrastructure
- improve extraction reliability
- improve confidence logic
- improve product matching
- make verdicts strict and explainable
- make manual fallback feel intentional

Long-term:

- live market comps

- stronger category coverage
- screenshot upload
- browser extension
- richer account history
- alerts
- paid detailed reports

17. How A GPT Or Developer Should Understand The Current Product

The current version is functional and live, but it is not finished.

It can:

- authenticate users
- save and sync items
- accept product links
- safely attempt extraction
- reject low-confidence prices
- ask for missing details
- match against internal benchmarks
- score listings with stricter confidence-aware logic
- show a cleaner verdict page

It cannot:

- guarantee extraction from every site
- fully replace live marketplace data
- scrape Facebook Marketplace
- know exact market value for unsupported products
- score confidently when the product or price is uncertain

The correct product promise today is:

Paste a product link. BuyWise will analyze what it can safely verify, ask for anything missing, and give a strict buyer-focused verdict using the current benchmarks.